SETUP GUIDE · MAC

Setting up *The Assistant*

Six short steps, about fifteen minutes, and you only do it once. Every step is one thing to click or one line to paste. Go in order and don't skip ahead.

BEFORE YOU START, YOU NEED

one

A Mac

Any recent Mac. A Windows guide comes later.

two

A Claude plan, Pro or higher

The Assistant runs on your own Claude account. The free plan doesn't include the part of Claude it lives in.

three

An external hard drive

Where your shoots are kept. If your photos live on your computer for now, it still works, and the Assistant will talk to you about it once.

four

Fifteen quiet minutes

And your internet on. Nothing here costs anything extra.

The six steps

1. Install Claude on your Mac
2. Make a folder for the Assistant
3. Install the Assistant (two lines to paste)
4. Turn on updates
5. Let it work while you're away
6. Say hi

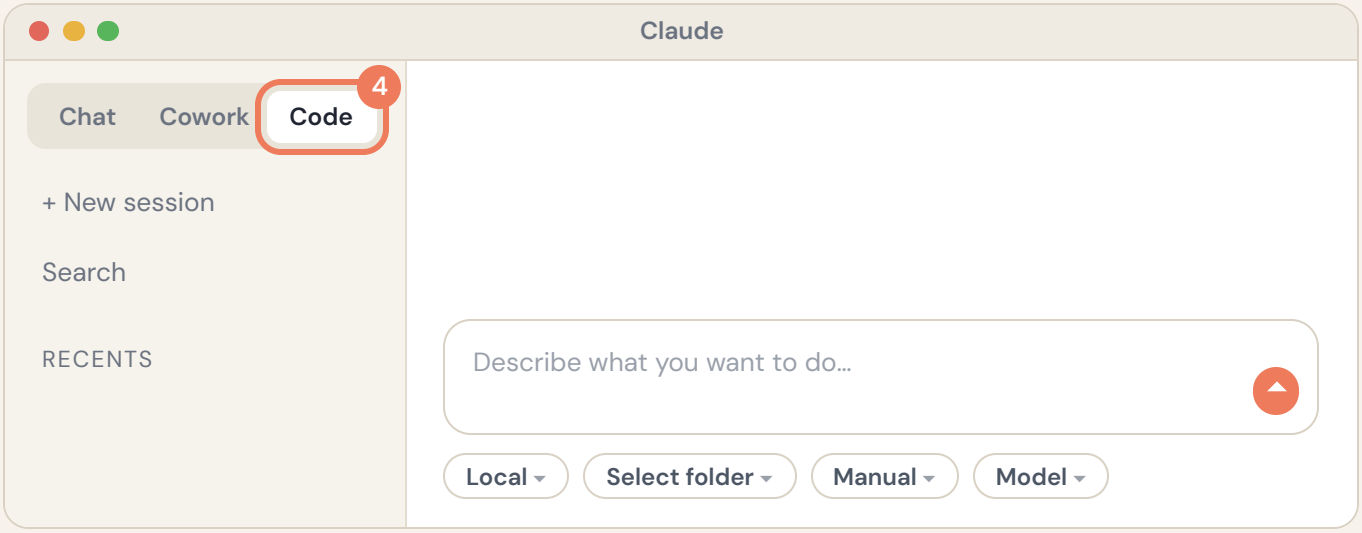
The pictures in this guide are drawings, not photos of the screen. Yours may look a little different. The words to click are the same.

STEP 1 OF 6 · ABOUT 3 MINUTES

1 Install Claude on your Mac

Claude is the app the Assistant lives inside. If Claude is already on your Mac and you're signed in, skip to number 4.

1. Open Safari and go to **claude.ai/download**.
2. Click the download for **Mac**. When it finishes, open the downloaded file and drag **Claude** into your **Applications** folder.
3. Open **Claude** from Applications and **sign in** with your Claude account.
4. Look at the top of the left column. Click **Code**.



*Drawing. The word to click is **Code**, at the top of the left column.*

You'll know it worked when you see a big message box with a row of small choices under it.

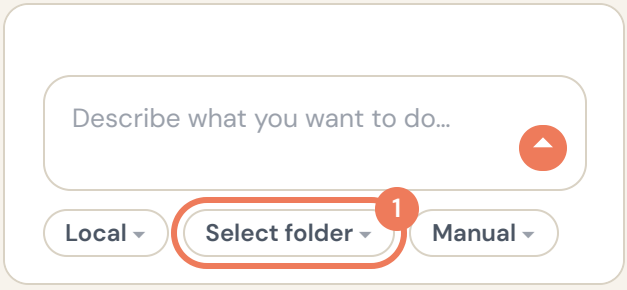
If it asks you to upgrade: your Claude plan doesn't include Code yet. You need Pro or higher. **If it asks you to sign in online:** follow the link, then come back to the app.

STEP 2 OF 6 · ABOUT 1 MINUTE

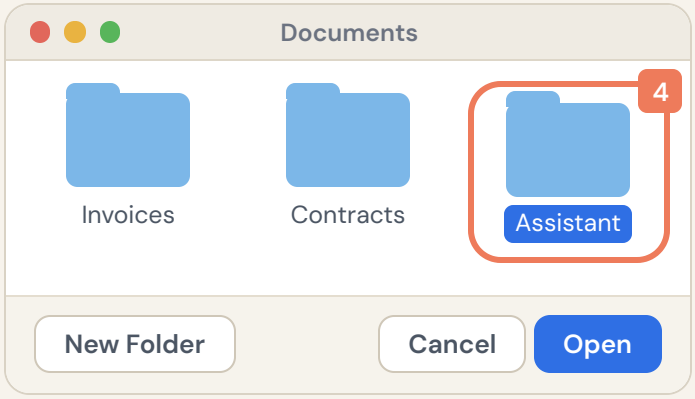
2 Make a folder for the Assistant

The Assistant needs one small folder of its own to keep its notes in. **Your photos never go in this folder.**

1. In the row under the message box, click the **folder** choice. (It may say "Select folder".)
2. Click **Open folder…** A window opens showing your files.
3. On the left of that window, click **Documents**.
4. Click **New Folder** at the bottom left. Type **Assistant** and click **Create**.
5. With the new **Assistant** folder selected, click **Open**.



Drawing. The folder choice, under the message box.



Drawing. Make the folder, then click Open.

You'll know it worked when the folder choice under the message box now says **Assistant**.

Why a new, empty folder? It keeps the Assistant separate from everything else on your Mac. You'll come back to this same folder every time you open it.

STEP 3 OF 6 · ABOUT 2 MINUTES

3 Install the Assistant

Two lines to paste, one after the other. Copy each one **exactly**, from the first slash to the last letter.

1. Click inside the message box. Copy this line, paste it in, and press Return.

LINE 1 · COPY ALL OF IT

```
/plugin marketplace add https://github.com/horizonfound/hf-tools
```

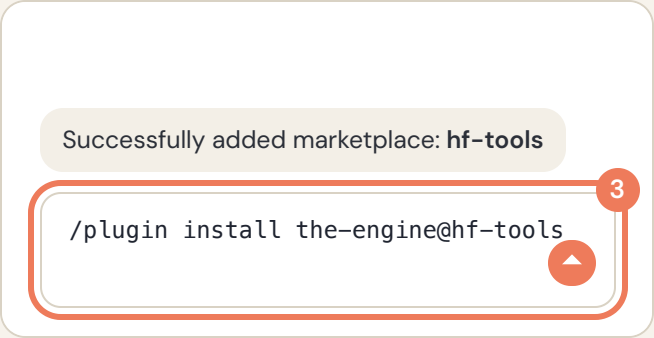
2. Wait for the reply. It says it **added hf-tools**.

3. Copy this second line, paste it in, and press Return.

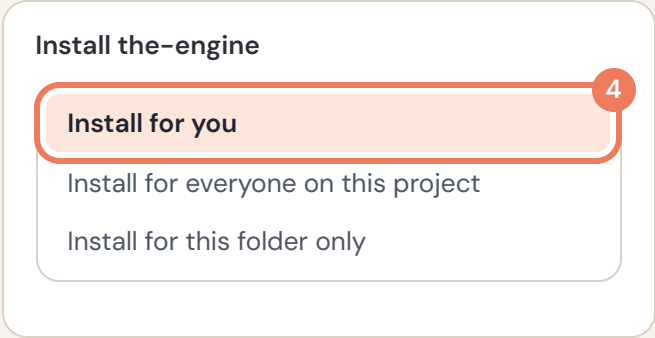
LINE 2 · COPY ALL OF IT

```
/plugin install the-engine@hf-tools
```

4. If it asks who to install it for, choose **Install for you**.



Drawing. The reply to line 1, and line 2 pasted in.



Drawing. If you're asked, pick the first one.

You'll know it worked when the reply says the-engine was **installed**. ("the-engine" is the Assistant's behind-the-scenes name.)

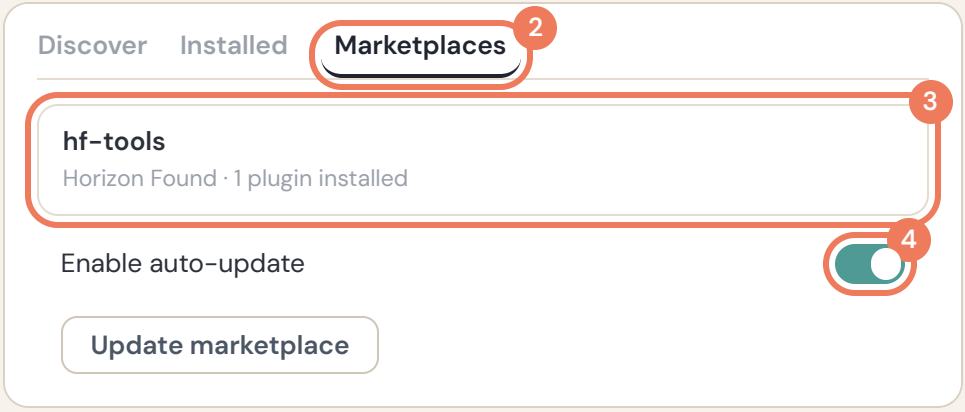
If a line does nothing or you get an error: check that nothing was cut off when you copied it, and that there's no space before the first slash. Then paste it again.

STEP 4 OF 6 · ABOUT 1 MINUTE

4 Turn on updates

The Assistant gets better every week. Updates are **off** until you switch them on. Do it once and you never think about it again.

1. Click inside the message box, type `/plugin` and press `Return`. A panel opens.
2. At the top of the panel, click **Marketplaces**.
3. Click **hf-tools**.
4. Turn on **Enable auto-update**.
5. Close the panel. (Press `Esc`.)



Drawing. Marketplaces, then hf-tools, then the switch.

You'll know it worked when the switch next to **Enable auto-update** is on.

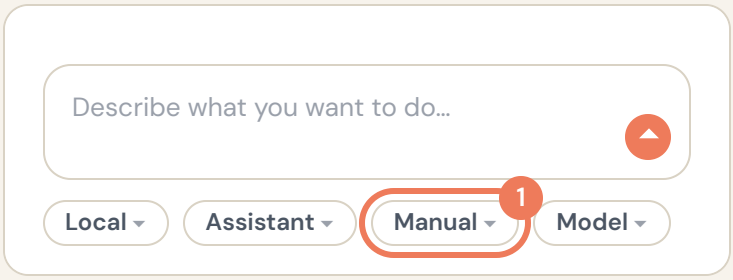
Good to know: updates arrive on their own a few minutes after you start talking to the Assistant, and take effect the next time you open Claude. If we ever tell you "we just fixed that," come back to this same panel and click **Update marketplace**.

STEP 5 OF 6 · ABOUT 30 SECONDS

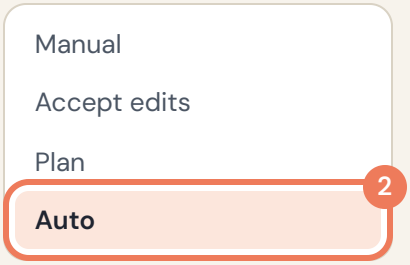
5 Let it work while you're away

This is the step that makes "walk away" true. Without it, Claude stops every few seconds to ask "may I do this?", and a backup can't finish while you're out of the room.

1. In the row under the message box, find the choice that says **Manual**. Click it.
2. In the list that opens, click **Auto**.



Drawing. Click Manual.



Drawing. Then click Auto.

You'll know it worked when that choice now says **Auto**. Claude remembers it for your Assistant folder.

Is this safe? Auto means Claude does the backup's steps without asking each time, with its own safety checks running. And the Assistant has its own rule that nothing may break, in any mode: **nothing on your memory card is ever deleted, moved or changed.**

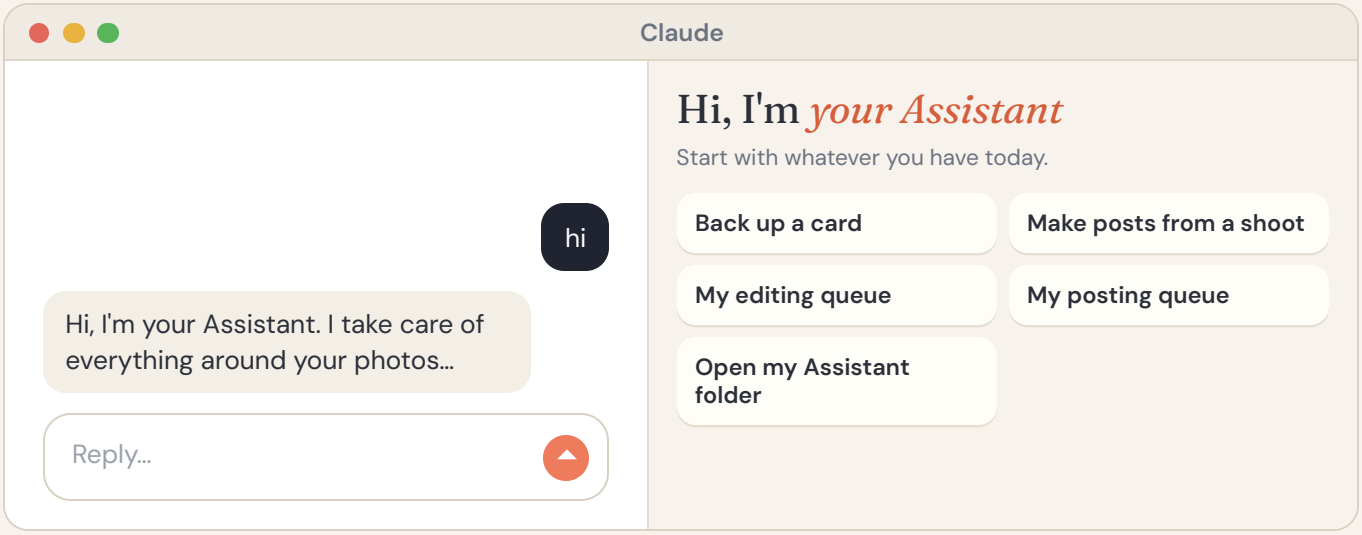
Don't see Auto in the list? In the same row, click the **Model** choice and pick the newest Claude model. Then look again.

STEP 6 OF 6 · YOU'RE THERE

6 Say hi

That's the setup. Now meet your Assistant.

1. Click inside the message box, type **hi** and press **Return**.
2. Give it a few seconds. The Assistant introduces itself, and its home page opens beside the chat.

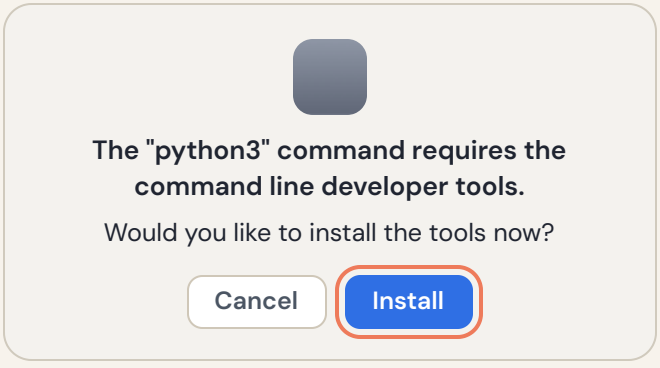


Drawing. The chat on the left, the Assistant's home page on the right.

One thing you might see first, on a newer Mac

A window from Apple may pop up asking to install **command line developer tools**. That's one free piece from Apple that the Assistant runs on.

1. Click **Install**, then **Agree**.
2. Wait five to ten minutes until it says it's done.
3. Go back to Claude and type **done**.



Drawing. You only ever see this once.

You're set up. From now on, opening the Assistant is: open Claude, click **Code**, click your **Assistant** folder, say **hi**.

YOU'RE IN

Two good places to *start*

You don't need a memory card to begin. Start with whatever you have today. You talk to the Assistant in your own words, the way you'd talk to a person.

Photos you've *already finished*

Edited and exported, sitting in a folder.

1. On the home page, click **Make posts from a shoot**.
2. Follow the box that opens. The first time, it has you paste **set up my Assistant folder**.
3. Click **Select the folder with your finished photos** and pick your exports.
4. Paste **make my posts** in the chat.

You get single posts, a carousel, stories and a reel, with captions written from what you tell it. Your originals aren't moved or changed.

A *memory card* with new photos

Straight out of the camera.

1. Put the card in and plug in your drive.
2. Type **backup now** in the chat.
3. The first time only, it asks a few quick questions with buttons.
4. When it says **You can walk away**, walk away.

When you're back, click **Show the report** in the chat. Every photo is copied and checked, sorted into named shoots, with six sneak peeks picked to edit first.

If something isn't right

The page beside the chat is blank, or shows a play button	Don't press the play button. Type **show the Assistant** and the page comes back.
Claude keeps asking "may I run this?"	Step 5 slipped back. In the row under the message box, change **Manual** to **Auto**.
A window from Apple asks to install something	That's the one free piece the Assistant runs on. Click **Install**. See Step 6.
A backup stopped	The Assistant says why, first thing, in plain words. Fix that (plug the drive in, clear space) and say **backup now** again. Nothing is copied twice.
You're not sure what to do next	Say **hi**. It tells you where things stand and what you can say.

Three promises: nothing on your memory card is ever changed. Nothing is ever deleted. Nothing is ever posted or sent for you.